



Invacuation Policy

Document Details

Organisation:	Fable House
Current Version Number:	1
Current Document Approved By:	L Latham
Date Approved:	August 2025
Next Review Date:	August 2026

Document Revision and Approval History

Version	Date	Version Created By:	Version Approved By:	Comments
001	25/08/2025	Jessica Fox	L Latham	

Policy Aims

This policy outlines our invacuation procedures should the setting receive warning of a threat to our community.

The safety of children, staff members and visitors on the premises is paramount and Fable House has a duty to protect the wellbeing and welfare of all who attend the site. The main priority is to prevent an emergency from occurring within the setting; however, this is not always within the control of the setting. In an emergency, staff members at the school will endeavour to take all reasonable actions in order to ensure the safety of children. The procedures outlined in this policy aim to minimise disruption to the learning environment whilst ensuring the safety of all students, staff members and visitors.

Definitions

The term 'invacuation' refers to the process of making staff members aware of an emergency and moving children, staff members and visitors to the most sheltered areas within the building. This procedure is employed if moving outside would increase the risk of harm to people, e.g. as a response to a security threat, or to toxic fumes in the air.

An 'evacuation' is the orderly removal of children, staff members and visitors from the site buildings; this can be as a result of a fire or other incident within the building. All should follow the Fable House Fire evacuation procedure.

Purpose

The purpose of having invacuation procedures is to ensure that we have an even safer and more secure learning environment for our students.

Invacuation procedures may be activated in response to any number of situations, these may include, but are not limited to:

- A reported incident or disturbance in the local community (with the potential to pose a risk to students and staff in the school)
- An intruder on the school site (with the potential to pose a risk to students and members of staff)
- A serious injury or death of a member of the community on the school site
- A warning received regarding a risk locally, of air pollution (e.g. smoke plume, gas cloud)
- A major fire in the vicinity of the school
- The close proximity of an animal roaming loose, e.g. dog

Legislation and statutory responsibilities

Department for Education (2024) [School and college security - GOV.UK](#)

Department for Education (2025) [Protective security and preparedness for the education sector](#)

Roles and Responsibilities

All staff members will act in accordance with the Schools' Invacuation Policy at all times, when required.

CEO

- It is the CEO's responsibility to ensure effective and rehearsed emergency procedures are in place at Fable house.
- The CEO is responsible for raising the alarm of an emergency and will delegate this duty to a designated member of staff to carry out when they are not present at the setting
- The CEO is responsible for the approval of any changes to invacuation procedures and/or this policy

DSL

- It is the responsibility of the DSL to ensure that new staff members are trained in implementing all the emergency procedures as part of Safeguarding induction training
- The DSL is responsible for ensuring that all staff members are aware of the policy and understand when and how this procedure will be implemented.

Invacuation Response Team

- The Invacuation Response Team are responsible for following the invacuation procedures in the event of an emergency as outlined in this policy
- The Invacuation Response Team are responsible for recording all evacuation procedures in the Invacuation Record Log.
- The Invacuation Response Team will meet to review the effectiveness of the invacuation procedures after an incident, adapting if necessary and seeking the CEO's approval of the changes

Tutors and Educational Support Workers

- Tutors and Educational Support Workers will communicate and discuss the invacuation procedure with their students in a manner that is appropriate to their individual needs and designed to minimise anxiety or distress
- Staff members will inform the Attendance Officer of any child missing when the alarm was raised

All Staff

- All staff will ensure they have thorough knowledge of invacuation procedures and will seek advice and support from their line manager or a member of the Invacuation Response Team should they have any queries or concerns
- All staff members are responsible for maintaining a calm and orderly environment during emergency procedures. This includes actively supporting students through co-regulation strategies to help them manage their emotions and remain composed throughout the process
- All staff members are responsible for ensuring children, fellow staff members and visitors remain as safe as possible whilst on the premises
- It is the responsibility of all staff members to ensure that registers are accurately taken and the names of missing children are immediately reported to the Invacuation Response Team in the event of an emergency

Invacuation Response Team

The Invacuation Response Team consists of the CEO, the Health and Safety Lead, the Designated Safeguarding Lead and Deputy and the Site Manager.

Invacuation Process

- When a member of staff is alerted to a threat they must immediately inform a member of the Invacuation Response Team in person.
- The Invacuation Response Team, where practically possible, should meet in the main office to coordinate the school response.
- The Invacuation Response Team will complete a dynamic risk assessment and decide on the appropriate level of lockdown.
- If relevant, a member of The Invacuation Team will take responsibility for informing the relevant external services, such as the police. The designated member of staff will continue to liaise with police instruction. Where there is an immediate risk to life, emergency services such as the police must be contacted immediately with the most up to date incident report.

Lockdown Door System

The building is equipped with an automatic lockdown door system designed to secure all entry and exit points during an invacuation. When activated, the system automatically locks all external doors and will not allow anyone to enter or leave the building. This ensures that all occupants remain safely inside until the situation has been resolved.

To ensure reliability, the system is tested weekly on Tuesdays between 8:45 a.m. and 9:15 a.m. During this period, doors may temporarily lock and unlock as part of the testing process.

Lockdown

There are three levels of lockdown, this will be determined by the Invacuation Team following analysis of the incident report;

Level 1 – Low Level Response

(Examples – Informed by police of a situation within the local community – such as a terrorist incident in Armitage bridge, an armed member of the community within local area – posing no direct threat to the school/students/staff)

- This level of response is likely to be actioned where there is a safeguarding risk in the community and therefore staff & students are not safe to leave the school site.
- Staff will be alerted to a Level 1 lockdown via the important information Whatsapp group and walkie talkies. This will be accompanied by the Invacuation Response Team/Senior Leadership Team circulating the building to ensure everyone has received the alert.
- The automatic lockdown door system will be engaged to prevent unauthorized exit from the building during lockdown
- All staff working off site will be alerted by phone call and asked not to return to the site until declared safe to do so
- At this level, staff and students must remain indoors and not make any attempt to leave the school site. Students and staff should continue with indoor activities. External doors & gates should be locked.
- The attendance officer should complete a register and ensure there are no missing students.
- Where appropriate, if the incident affects the end of the day, parents will be informed via text/email.

Level 2 – Medium Level Response

(Examples – A possible violent member of the public/student/adult who is within the school grounds, who is deemed to be in a contained area, i.e. Garden/reception).

- This level of response is likely to be actioned where there is an immediate safeguarding risk. At this level, there is a risk of harm on the school site.
- Staff will be alerted to a Level 2 lockdown via the important information Whatsapp group and walkie talkies. This will be accompanied by the Invacuation Response Team/Senior Leadership Team circulating the building to ensure everyone has received the alert
- The automatic lockdown door system will be engaged to prevent unauthorized exit from the building during lockdown
- All staff working off site will be alerted by phone call and asked not to return to the site until declared safe to do so
- Students must remain inside their current classroom or make their way to a secure classroom with the member of staff supervising them.
- All doors and windows should be closed.
- Non-teaching staff or teachers not timetabled should remain in their office bases eg ICT suite , Conference Room , Staff room .
- Tutors should complete a register and notify the Attendance Officer of any missing students.
- Students can continue with their lessons in the classroom.
- Where appropriate, if the incident affects the end of the day, parents will be informed via text/email.

Level 3 – High Level Response

(Example – uncontained intruder/person on the school site with the intent to harm. This may include a person with a weapon/device with the intention to endanger life).

- This level of response is likely to be actioned where there is an immediate and serious safeguarding risk in the school and therefore staff & students must act immediately.
- Staff and students will be notified immediately by Walkie talkie.
- The automatic lockdown door system will be engaged to prevent unauthorized exit from the building during lockdown
- Communication via mobile/email must also take place to inform all whether on or off the main site.
- Students and staff must not make any attempt to leave the school site or the area that they are in when notified.
- Students and staff must remain in the classroom they are in, they must lock the classroom door from the inside and barricade with tables if the door cannot lock.
- Where sessions are taking place in an open area, staff and students should move to the nearest secure classroom/office.
- During an outdoor session, where the risk is within the school building, all students outside should be moved to the café area for safety.
- Students and staff should, where possible, remain out of sight and away from windows and doors once barricaded in.
- Lights should be switched off.

- Students and staff should hide under classroom desks and remain in that position until notified not to do so.
- Teachers/staff should complete a register and notify the Attendance Officer of any missing students via walkie talkie
- The Head Teacher & Invacuation Response Team will decide when it is safe for the invacuation to be over following direct advice from emergency services, this will be communicated via walkie talkie to all staff
- The Invacuation Response Team and Senior Leadership Team will circulate the building to ensure all staff and students are aware that the threat has ended and to check on welfare
- Parents will be informed via text/phone call once site is deemed safe by emergency services by the Invacuation Response Team

After an Incident

Following an occurrence necessitating an invacuation procedure, the following actions will be taken:

- A follow up talk with staff members and students will be delivered by the CEO
- Parents/carers and other stakeholders will be informed via written communication
- Emotional support will be sought where necessary, such as counsellors
- The response to the crisis will be evaluated by the Invacuation Response Team and procedures amended where necessary

Drills

Due to the nature of our student cohort and their diverse needs and disabilities, full invacuation drills will not be conducted, as these may cause undue distress or pose risks to their wellbeing.

To ensure staff are well-prepared to respond effectively in an emergency, we will implement comprehensive training every six months and as part of the induction process for new staff members. This will include both physical training exercises and table-top simulations to reinforce procedures and staff readiness.

Linked Policies

Health and Safety Policy

Safeguarding Policy

Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed annually or sooner in the event of a post-invacuation review or change to legislation